



INTERVIEW | MAYAWATI

“I am a hard-working girl”

Dressed in a simple yellow salwar kameez, the glow on Mayawati's face reflects her electoral high. Fresh from her rallies in the faraway south, she spoke to Editor PRABHU CHAWLA and Assistant Editor PRIYA SAHGAL about her plans. Excerpts:

Q. Why are you going beyond UP and touring different parts of the country as well?

A. Apart from being a chief minister, I am also the national president of my party. So I have to take care of the party in other states as well as in UP.

Q. But Uttar Pradesh is such a backward state. Shouldn't you concentrate more on it?

A. I have no hassles handling UP. For 57 years, the state has been ruled by non-BSP parties which is why it is so backward. In my first term as the chief

minister, in four months I did the work of four years.

Q. Is the next prime minister going to be from the state?

A. (laughs) I will change the face of Uttar Pradesh first.

Q. Why are you now talking about your security? Are you scared?

A. I am not scared while I am in Uttar Pradesh. But after BSP got an absolute majority there and began